

Sportstar. “I think this will only get bigger. The constituent elements – from grassroots, local championships to the Asian championships and then a team at all these levels. That’s what I call a full-stack tournament sector.”

“I think the opportunity is to see if we can go out and get a world championship to come to India. And our next pursuit would be to try to go over and get that done. Because if we can go out and get that done, again, that cycle starts happening where internationals will be coming to India. We’ve done this before when we wanted to go into ESL — one in Mumbai. We’ve gone and done this with all the big tournaments that NODWIN does at our level. It’s a formula that works for us, and that’s the next step for VALORANT,” Rathee adds.

As the game completed five years, Riot Games organised a campaign named V5 to celebrate players from South Asia, who comprise over five million of VALORANT’s gamer base.



The campaign also involved a cheeky marketing jibe in Kota, the hub of students preparing for competitive exams.

On its official launch date, June 2, which also happened to be the day when the results of IIT-Joint Entrance Examinations (JEE-Advance) were announced.

Riot Games rolled out its own billboards, not for engineering aspirants but for ‘VAL Toppers’, the Radiant-ranked VALORANT players, honouring them with the same visual fanfare usually reserved for toppers in competitive exams.

“V5 is our ‘Thank You’ to a generation of players who made VALORANT their own,” said Arun Rajappa, country manager, Riot Games India & South Asia. “Whether you’re top-fragging in ranked matches or reminiscing over your first LAN, this campaign is about your story.”



Did you know? Former Manchester United goalkeeper and two-time Europa League winner David de Gea is the owner of esports organisation Rebels Gaming.

RONALDO AND SON-HEUNG MIN CONTINUE ESPORTS PRESENCE OF PROFESSIONAL FOOTBALLERS



Portugal legend Cristiano Ronaldo may still be scoring goals and winning trophies at will, but his presence in esports continues to rise. Earlier this year, he was announced as a playable character in the popular Japanese fighting game Fatal Fury: City of the

Wolves. On June 13, he was announced as the Global Ambassador of the inaugural Esports World Cup, set to be played in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, between July 8 to August 24.

South Korea and Tottenham Hotspur star Son Heung-Min is another footballer who looks to enter the esports scene through a collaboration with Fortnite.

WHO AM I?

Once one of the most popular pro Dota 2 players from India, I retired from the game in 2020 and pivoted to mobile MOBAs, becoming a top Pokémon UNITE player with Revenant XSpark.

The answer will be revealed in the next issue.

*Answer to previous issue’s quiz:
Jonathan Jude Amaral*



BUSINESS OF ESPORTS

Riot Games secured a strategic partnership with marketing agency, T/SQUARED, to enhance sponsorship sales and business development for its key esports properties in Europe, the Middle East, and Africa (EMEA).



EASTER EGG ‘FRAG’

Frag refers to neutralising someone in a death match. Typically, it means killing a competitor virtually and temporarily in a gaming contest.

Rankings and quiz powered by NODWIN Gaming